4.3.4 Putting it all together

Listing 4.4 adds an `isPreflight` method to the sample app that detects whether an incoming request is a preflight request. The `isPreflight` method checks three things:

- Is the request an HTTP `OPTIONS` request?
- Does the request have an Origin header?
- Does the request have an Access-Control-Request-Method header?

Listing 4.4 Checking if the request is a preflight

```
var isPreflight = function(req) {
  var isHttpOptions = req.method === 'OPTIONS';
  var hasOriginHeader = req.headers['origin'];
  var hasRequestMethod = req.headers['access-control-request-method'];
  return isHttpOptions && hasOriginHeader && hasRequestMethod;
};

var handleCors = function(req, res, next) {
  res.set('Access-Control-Allow-Origin', 'http://localhost:1111');
  if (isPreflight(req)) {
    console.log('Received a preflight request!');
    res.status(204).end();
    return;
  }
  next();
};
```

Is the request an HTTP OPTIONS request?

Does the request have an Origin header?

Does the request have an Access-Control-Request-Method header?

If request is a preflight, stops processing it and displays a message.

If all three criteria are true, the request is a preflight. If you reload the sample and click a Delete link, you should see the text "Received a preflight request!" in the server's terminal window, as shown in figure 4.10.

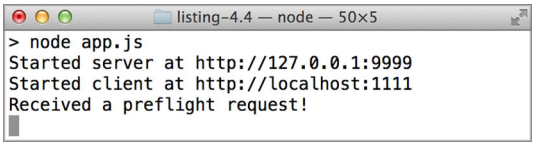


Figure 4.10 The server successfully received a preflight request.

This verifies that the server has detected a preflight request. But the request still fails because you aren't responding to the preflight. Next you'll learn how to respond to the preflight.

4.4 Responding to a preflight request

Now that you have detected the preflight request, the server needs to respond so that the browser can make the actual request. The server's preflight response, shown in figure 4.11, grants permissions to make the HTTP request. These permissions are granted by setting HTTP headers on the response. This section will show which HTTP headers the server needs to set to respond to a preflight, and how to reject a preflight if the request isn't allowed.